D Lent 1 Grammar notes

The Subjunctive Mood

- The subjunctive is NOT a tense. It is a "**mood**" which may be thought of as another "set of tenses" that is used in special circumstances. You have already met it in D Mich 3. (All the other tenses you have learned so far belong to a "set of tenses" called the **indicative mood.** The only two tenses of the subjunctive mood that you will need at this stage are the PRESENT SUBJUNCTIVE, and perhaps the PERFECT SUBJUNCTIVE.)

- You need to know HOW to form the subjunctive, WHEN to use it and WHEN NOT to use it.

How to form the Subjunctive Mood

- To form the present subjunctive:

    - Take the **ILS** form of the **present tense**.
    - **Remove the ENT and replace with the SUBJUNCTIVE ending**:
    - **e, es, e, ions, iez, ent.**
    - Je FINISSe, il VENDe, nous MANGions, ils JETTent

- Some common **irregular** verbs to LEARN:

    - **ALLER**: aille, ailles, aille, allions, alliez, aillent
    - **AVOIR**: aie, aies, ait, ayons, ayez, aient
    - **ÊTRE**: sois, sois, soit, soyons, soyez, soient
    - **FAIRE**: fasse, fasses, fasse, fassions, fassiez, fassent
    - **POUVOIR**: puisse, puisses, puisse, puissions, puissiez, puissent
    - **SAVOIR**: sache, saches, sache, sachions, sachiez, sachent
    - **VOULOIR**: veuille, veuilles, veuille, voulions, vouliez, veuillent

- Some **SEMI-irregular**, in that NOUS and VOUS are the same as the imperfect tense, otherwise they are regular.

    - APPELER, BOIRE, CROIRE (eg: boive, boives, boive, BUVIONS, BUVIEZ, boivent)
    - DEVOIR, ENVOYER, JETER
    - MOURIR, PRENDRE, RECEVOIR
    - TENIR, VENIR, VOIR

- To form the **PERFECT SUBJUNCTIVE** is straightforward. The auxiliary verb, **AVOIR or ÊTRE goes into the present subjunctive**, and **the past participle is added as usual**. The rules of agreement remain unchanged.

    - *Il est dommage que tu ne SOIS pas venu*

- *Il est dommage qu'ils n'AIENT pas fini leurs devoirs.*

When to use the Subjunctive Mood

- Compare the following pairs of sentences:

I want to read	I want *David* to read
He prefers being well dressed	He prefers *his mum* to be well dressed
We don't like to be late	We don't like *him* being late

- In the first column, the **same person/subject potentially performs the action of both verbs** (I want and I read, He prefers and He is well dressed, We don't like and we are late). In the second column, there is a **CHANGE OF SUBJECT**: the first person does the wanting/liking/preferring and a DIFFERENT PERSON is involved in the second verb (*I do the wanting but DAVID does the reading, He does the preferring but HIS mum is the one who is well dressed, we do the not liking but HE is the one who is late*).

- It is important to differentiate when there is a change of subject (COS) and when there is not. **If there is no COS then the following verb will be in the infinitive as usual:**

  - *Je veux lire; il préfère être bien habillé; on n'aime pas être en retard.*

- When there is a COS after a verb of wanting/liking/preferring (all "emotive" verbs in the sense that they convey an "emotive" quality that is not present in neutral statements of fact or certainty such as "I know that...) then the COS is introduced by the word **QUE** and the next verb must be in the subjunctive mood:

  - *Je veux QU'il LISE; il préfère QUE sa mère SOIT bien habillée; on n'aime pas QU'il SOIT en retard*.

- The subjunctive must be used after **virtually** ANY "**emotive**" verb or verbal expression **that introduces a COS** (*vouloir que, préférer que, douter que, être content/triste/surpris que etc*). More detail will be given in subsequent chapters.

  - *Je suis content que tu sois là. Il doute que je puisse le faire.*
  - *Nous ne voulons pas qu'elle vienne ce soir. Je veux qu'elle aille ailleurs.*
  - *Je suis surpris que tu ne saches pas parler anglais.*
  - *Il est furieux que je sois allé au cinéma sans lui.*
  - *Elle sera ravie que tu puisses lui rendre visite.*